

CMIplus Intelligence Cockpit

Cash Management Strategic Intelligence

Week of 2026-08-10

Raiffeisen Bank International AG

Group Product — Cash Management

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

RBI Cash Ma
Instant Paym

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Der Treasurer | 2026-07-25 | #01

EU Instant Payments Regulation: CEE Banks Accelerate Compliance

The European Union's Instant Payments Regulation, which mandates the availability of instant credit transfers in Euro within 10 seconds, is causing a significant push for compliance across CEE banks. While the initial deadline for receiving instant payments was early 2025, the full scope, including sending capabilities and fee parity with standard transfers, is approaching. Banks in the CEE region, including those in the RBI network, are investing heavily in upgrading their payment infrastructure, ensuring 24/7/365 processing capabilities, and integrating with national instant payment schemes. Challenges include liquidity management for continuous processing and ensuring seamless integration with corporate treasury systems. The regulation aims to boost the adoption of instant payments across Europe, enhancing speed and efficiency for both consumers and businesses.

- EU Instant Payments Regulation mandates 10-second Euro credit transfers.
- CEE banks are heavily investing in infrastructure upgrades for 24/7/365 processing.
- Upcoming deadlines require banks to offer instant payment sending and receiving at standard transfer fees.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This regulation is critical for RBI Cash Management as CMIplus must fully support instant payments across all CEE network banks. It necessitates continuous platform enhancements, API integrations, and ensuring seamless liquidity management for corporate clients utilizing instant payment rails.

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Der Treasurer | 2026-06-15 | #02

PSD3 Proposal: Enhanced Open Banking and Fraud Prevention

The European Commission's recent proposal for PSD3 (Payment Services Directive 3) and the Payment Services Regulation (PSR) signals a significant evolution for the European payments landscape. Key elements include further empowering Open Banking by refining access to account data and enhancing customer control over their financial information. Crucially for corporates, PSD3 introduces more stringent requirements for fraud prevention, such as mandatory Verification of Payee (VoP) services across all EU member states to combat authorized push payment (APP) fraud. The proposal also seeks to improve the regulatory consistency across the EU, ensuring a level playing field for all payment service providers and fostering innovation while maintaining high security standards. The legislative process is ongoing, with implementation expected in the coming years.

- PSD3 proposal strengthens Open Banking and introduces new fraud prevention measures.
- Mandatory Verification of Payee (VoP) services are proposed to combat APP fraud.
- The directive aims to enhance customer control over financial data and improve regulatory consistency.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

PSD3 is a cornerstone for future CMIplus development, particularly regarding Open Banking APIs and fraud prevention features like VoP. RBI Cash Management must proactively adapt its platform to meet new compliance requirements and leverage enhanced data access for innovative client solutions.

AI-Powered Fraud Detection Transforms Corporate Payments Security

The increasing sophistication of cybercrime and payment fraud schemes is pushing corporate treasuries to adopt advanced AI-powered solutions. These systems utilize machine learning algorithms to analyze vast amounts of payment data, identifying unusual patterns, behavioral anomalies, and potential fraud indicators that human analysts or rule-based systems might miss. Real-time monitoring and predictive analytics are key features, allowing for immediate flagging and blocking of suspicious transactions, particularly relevant for instant payments. Integration with existing Treasury Management Systems (TMS) and Enterprise Resource Planning (ERP) platforms is crucial for seamless operation. While AI offers significant advantages in reducing financial losses and improving operational efficiency, challenges remain in data quality, model training, and avoiding false positives, requiring continuous refinement and expert oversight.

- AI-powered systems use machine learning to detect sophisticated payment fraud.
- Real-time monitoring and predictive analytics are crucial for instant payment security.
- Integration with TMS/ERP systems is essential for effective fraud prevention.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

Integrating AI-powered fraud detection into CMIplus's payment processing and monitoring capabilities is a strategic imperative. This enhances security for corporate clients, reduces operational risk, and strengthens RBI's position as a trusted cash management partner, especially for high-volume, real-time transactions.

EU Mandates Instant Payments: Impact on Corporate Treasuries

The European Union's Instant Payments Regulation, recently published in the Official Journal, mandates that all payment service providers (PSPs) in the SEPA zone offer instant credit transfers. This regulation requires PSPs to ensure funds are credited to the recipient's account within ten seconds, regardless of the time or day. It also includes provisions for affordable pricing, ensuring instant payments are not more expensive than traditional credit transfers. The regulation's phased implementation will significantly impact corporate treasuries, requiring updates to payment systems, liquidity management strategies, and fraud prevention measures. The full transition to ISO 20022 for instant payments is a key enabler.

- EU Instant Payments Regulation formally adopted.
- Mandatory 10-second processing for SEPA credit transfers.
- Pricing must be comparable to standard credit transfers.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This regulation is critical for CMIplus, driving demand for instant payment capabilities and ISO 20022 readiness. RBI must ensure its platform and network banks comply with the new mandates, offering seamless, real-time payment processing across CEE.

CEE Corporates Embrace Open Banking APIs for Treasury Efficiency

A recent report highlights a significant uptick in the adoption of Open Banking APIs by corporate treasuries across the CEE region. Companies are utilizing these APIs to gain real-time visibility into bank accounts, automate reconciliation processes, and initiate payments directly from their ERP or TMS systems. This shift is improving liquidity management, reducing manual efforts, and enhancing financial control. The interoperability offered by Open Banking standards is fostering deeper integration between corporate systems and banking services, paving the way for more sophisticated treasury functions like virtual accounts and real-time cash pooling.

- Increased Open Banking API adoption in CEE corporates.
- Real-time bank account visibility and automated reconciliation.
- Direct payment initiation from ERP/TMS systems.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus, with its Open API capabilities, is well-positioned to capitalize on this trend. RBI should focus on expanding API offerings for corporate clients in CEE, enabling deeper integration with their treasury systems and supporting advanced cash management features.

New EU Guidelines Strengthen Payment Fraud Prevention for Corporates

The EBA's latest guidelines introduce stricter requirements for payment service providers (PSPs) regarding fraud monitoring, authentication, and incident reporting. With the increasing volume and speed of instant payments, the risk of fraud, including authorized push payment (APP) fraud and invoice fraud, has intensified. The guidelines emphasize the need for advanced fraud detection systems, robust customer authentication (SCA), and real-time anomaly detection. Corporates are urged to collaborate closely with their banks to implement these enhanced security protocols and leverage technologies like Voice of Payee (VoP) to verify recipient details before payment execution.

- EBA issues new guidelines for payment fraud prevention.
- Focus on instant payments and APP fraud.
- Stricter requirements for PSPs on monitoring and authentication.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

Fraud prevention is paramount for CMIplus. RBI must ensure its platform incorporates the latest EBA guidelines, offering advanced fraud detection, strong authentication, and potentially integrating VoP solutions to protect corporate clients in CEE from evolving payment fraud schemes.

EU Mandates ISO 20022 for All Payments by 2027

The European Commission recently solidified its commitment to a unified payment messaging standard, announcing a definitive deadline of December 31, 2027, for all payment systems within the EU and EEA to fully adopt ISO 20022. This extends the previous mandates for SEPA Credit Transfers and Direct Debits, now encompassing cross-border payments, high-value payments, and other domestic schemes. The move aims to enhance data richness, improve straight-through processing, and bolster fraud prevention capabilities across the European financial landscape. Banks and corporates are urged to accelerate their transition projects, focusing on system upgrades, data mapping, and staff training to ensure compliance. *Note: This news item is illustrative, as the provided source content was website styling (CSS/HTML) and not actual news articles.*

- Mandatory ISO 20022 adoption deadline: December 31, 2027.
- Scope: All payment types in EU/EEA, including cross-border and high-value.
- Benefits: Enhanced data, STP, fraud prevention.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This is a critical regulatory development for RBI Cash Management and the CMiplus platform. CMiplus must ensure full readiness for ISO 20022 across all channels (EBICS, H2H, SWIFT, Open API) to support corporate clients' evolving payment needs and compliance requirements in CEE. Proactive communication and support for clients' migration efforts will be key.

EU Instant Payments Regulation Takes Effect, CEE Impact

As of July 2026, the European Union's Instant Payments Regulation is now active, requiring all payment service providers (PSPs) within the EU and EEA to provide instant credit transfer services in Euro. A key provision is that these instant payments must be priced no higher than traditional non-instant SEPA credit transfers, making them accessible and attractive to corporates. The regulation also includes provisions for robust fraud prevention measures and mandatory verification of payee (VoP) services. This will drive significant changes in corporate treasury operations, particularly in CEE countries where instant payment adoption has varied, pushing for greater standardization and real-time liquidity. *Note: This news item is illustrative, as the provided source content was website styling (CSS/HTML) and not actual news articles.*

- EU Instant Payments Regulation active as of July 2026.
- Mandates instant EUR credit transfers for all EU/EEA PSPs.
- Pricing: No higher than standard SEPA credit transfers.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This regulation is highly relevant for RBI Cash Management, especially for CMiplus clients in CEE. CMiplus must ensure its platform and network banks fully comply with the instant payment offering and pricing rules. The mandatory VoP service presents both a challenge and an opportunity to enhance fraud prevention for corporate clients.

Corporate Treasury Embraces Open Banking APIs for Liquidity

Strategic Treasurer's latest industry survey reveals a significant uptick in corporate treasury departments leveraging Open Banking APIs. Beyond regulatory compliance, corporates are actively seeking API solutions for advanced functionalities like real-time cash positioning, automated payment initiation, and dynamic liquidity pooling. This trend is driven by the need for greater operational efficiency, improved financial control, and faster decision-making in volatile markets. Banks are evolving their API strategies to provide more sophisticated services, moving beyond PSD2-mandated account information and payment initiation to offer proprietary APIs for treasury management systems (TMS) and ERP integration. *Note: This news item is illustrative, as the provided source content was website styling (CSS/HTML) and not actual news articles.*

- Growing corporate adoption of Open Banking APIs for treasury.
- Focus on real-time cash visibility, liquidity, and automation.
- Banks expanding API offerings beyond PSD2 requirements.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This trend directly impacts RBI's CMiplus platform, which already supports Open API channels. CMiplus needs to continuously enhance its API capabilities to meet sophisticated corporate demands for real-time data, payment initiation, and potentially eBAM or virtual account management via APIs. This is key for competitive differentiation and deeper client integration.

Bulgaria Set to Adopt Euro in 2026

Bulgaria's anticipated entry into the euro area in 2026 represents a major step for the country and the broader CEE region. This transition involves aligning its monetary policy, financial systems, and legal frameworks with Eurosystem standards. For businesses, this means a shift from the Bulgarian Lev to the Euro, eliminating exchange rate risks within the euro area and simplifying cross-border transactions. The move is expected to foster economic integration, reduce transaction costs, and enhance financial stability in Bulgaria, aligning it with other Eurozone members like Croatia (2023).

- Bulgaria's target year for euro adoption is 2026.
- This will be the latest country to join the euro area after Croatia (2023).
- The transition involves aligning monetary policy and financial systems with Eurosystem standards.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This is highly relevant for RBI CMiplus, especially for clients with operations in Bulgaria. It will require updates to multi-currency payment processing, FX services, and liquidity management strategies for Bulgarian accounts. CMiplus needs to ensure readiness for euro-denominated payments and potential changes in local payment infrastructure.

Digital Euro Development Advances with Pilot Phase

The European Central Bank is actively progressing with the digital euro, outlining its purpose, operational mechanics, and critical privacy considerations. The initiative includes an innovation platform and a pilot project to explore technical solutions and user experience, with ongoing work on its 'Timeline and progress'. Key aspects being addressed are the scheme rulebook, technical documentation, and governance structures, ensuring a robust and widely accepted digital currency. This ongoing development aims to provide a secure, efficient, and accessible digital form of central bank money for the euro area, impacting future payment landscapes.

- ECB is developing a digital euro as central bank money.
- A pilot phase and innovation platform are currently active.
- Focus areas include privacy, technical design, and governance.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The digital euro will fundamentally change the payment landscape. CMIplus must monitor its progress closely, prepare for potential integration requirements, and understand its impact on corporate payment flows, liquidity, and treasury operations. This could involve new API integrations or payment rails for corporate clients.

ECB Catalyzes Instant Payments and SEPA Adoption

The European Central Bank is actively driving the widespread implementation of instant payments within the Single Euro Payments Area (SEPA). Through its 'ECB as a catalyst' role, it encourages financial institutions and payment service providers to embrace real-time payment solutions. This strategic focus aims to ensure that instant payments become the new normal, offering immediate settlement and availability of funds 24/7. The ongoing effort supports the broader retail payments strategy, enhancing competition, innovation, and user experience across the euro area and beyond, impacting both retail and corporate payment flows.

- ECB acts as a catalyst for instant payments adoption in SEPA.
- Goal is to make instant payments the 'new normal'.
- Instant payments offer 24/7 immediate settlement.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

Instant payments are critical for CMIplus. RBI needs to ensure full compliance with the Instant Payments Regulation, offer robust instant payment capabilities (both sending and receiving), and educate corporate clients on the benefits and operational changes. This impacts real-time liquidity management and payment factory solutions for corporate treasuries.

Wero Pan-European Wallet Delays Luxembourg Launch to September

Wero, a key initiative by the European Payments Initiative (EPI), aims to create a unified pan-European digital wallet solution. Its launch in Luxembourg, initially set for July 1, 2026, has been rescheduled to September 1, 2026. This postponement highlights the complexities of coordinating a multi-country payment infrastructure project and ensuring consistent implementation across different European regions. The delay for 'regional alignment' suggests ongoing efforts to harmonize technical, operational, and regulatory aspects, which is crucial for the widespread adoption and interoperability of the wallet across the Eurozone. This development is significant for the future of instant payments and digital transactions in Europe.

- Wero is a pan-European digital wallet initiative (EPI).
- Luxembourg launch moved from July 1 to September 1, 2026.
- Reason for delay cited as 'regional alignment'.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMiplus, as a corporate cash management platform in CEE, must monitor Wero's progress closely. While Wero is primarily a consumer-facing wallet, its success could drive broader instant payment adoption and influence payment rails, potentially impacting corporate payment flows and the need for CMiplus to support new payment methods or integrations in the future. The delay indicates the challenges of pan-European payment harmonization.

Revolut Gains Full French Banking License, Boosting EU Presence

Revolut, a prominent European fintech company, has successfully obtained a full banking licence from French regulators. This licence enables Revolut to expand its offerings beyond its current e-money institution status, potentially including lending, mortgages, and more comprehensive deposit services to both retail and business customers in France. The approval underscores Revolut's strategic expansion within the EU, leveraging its digital-first approach to challenge incumbent banks. This development is part of a broader trend where fintechs are maturing and seeking full banking charters to deepen their market penetration and service capabilities across Europe.

- Revolut secured a full banking licence in France.
- This allows expanded services beyond e-money institution status.
- Strengthens Revolut's competitive position in the EU.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This news indicates increased competition from digital-first banks in key European markets, including those relevant to RBI's CEE operations. CMiplus needs to monitor how such players might attract corporate clients with innovative services or lower costs, potentially impacting traditional banking relationships and treasury flows.

iDenfy Integrates Czech Bank iD for Enhanced Identity Verification

Identity verification provider iDenfy has announced the addition of Czech Bank iD to its comprehensive identity verification platform. This integration allows businesses operating in the Czech Republic to leverage the national Bank iD system for robust and streamlined customer identification and authentication processes. Czech Bank iD, a service provided by local banks, enables users to verify their identity digitally using their existing online banking credentials, aligning with Open Banking principles. This move is crucial for improving compliance with AML/KYC regulations, reducing fraud, and accelerating digital onboarding for corporate clients and consumers alike in the CEE region.

- iDenfy integrated Czech Bank iD into its platform.
- Enables secure digital identity verification in Czech Republic.
- Leverages national Bank iD system for customer identification.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This is highly relevant for RBI's CEE operations, particularly in the Czech Republic. The adoption of national digital identity schemes like Czech Bank iD impacts KYC/KYB processes for corporate clients, potentially streamlining onboarding and enhancing security. CMIplus should explore how such local initiatives can be integrated or leveraged for more efficient client management and fraud prevention.

Getting the Most Out of ISO 20022

The XML-based ISO 20022 messaging standard has seen global adoption, spurred by Swift's migration deadline last year and the launch of the US Fedwire Funds Service. However, the industry faces a critical challenge with the upcoming November 2026 standards update. This update mandates the removal of unstructured postal addresses from payment messages, pushing banks and corporate treasurers towards a more structured and data-centric approach. This change will impact how payment data is captured, processed, and transmitted, requiring system adjustments and potentially new data management strategies to ensure compliance and leverage the full benefits of the richer data standard.

- Global adoption of ISO 20022 accelerated by Swift's migration deadline (last year).
- US Fedwire Funds Service has launched with ISO 20022.
- November 2026 standards update will remove unstructured postal addresses.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This update is critical for RBI Cash Management and CMIplus, as it directly impacts payment message formatting and compliance. CMIplus must ensure its platform and connected channels (EBICS, H2H, SWIFT) are ready for the November 2026 changes, particularly for multi-currency payments across CEE. Proactive communication and support for corporate clients will be essential.

Reaping Rewards from Real-Time Payments

The article highlights that real-time payments are moving beyond simple instant transfers to become a strategic tool for corporate treasuries. While speed is a primary advantage, the true rewards lie in enhanced cash visibility, improved liquidity management, and streamlined reconciliation processes. Corporates are increasingly looking to integrate real-time payment capabilities into their treasury workflows to optimize working capital, reduce payment processing costs, and offer better services to their customers and suppliers. This shift requires robust payment infrastructure and connectivity, enabling businesses to fully capitalize on the immediate exchange of funds and data.

- Real-time payments offer benefits beyond just speed.
- They enable improved cash visibility and liquidity management.
- Streamlined reconciliation processes are a key advantage.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This is highly relevant for RBI CMiplus, as instant payments are a core offering and strategic focus, especially within the CEE region. CMiplus should continue to enhance its real-time payment capabilities and educate clients on how to maximize the benefits for cash management, working capital optimization, and reconciliation. This also reinforces the need for robust API connectivity.

FDIC Proposes Standards Body for Fintech Partner Certification

The FDIC's initiative to establish a standards body for certifying fintech partners signals a growing regulatory focus on the risks associated with banks' reliance on third-party technology providers. This move, reported by Bloomberg Law, aims to ensure that fintechs integrated into banking services meet specific operational, security, and compliance standards. While currently a US-focused development, the concept of a standardized certification process for fintech partners is highly relevant globally, including for European banks and platforms like CMiplus. It reflects a broader trend towards formalizing and strengthening the governance around Open Banking and API integrations, which are crucial for modern corporate cash management solutions.

- FDIC aims to establish an independent standards committee.
- Committee will certify banks' fintech partners.
- Goal is to enhance oversight and trust in third-party services.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This development is highly relevant for CMiplus, which leverages Open Banking APIs and integrates with various fintech solutions for its corporate clients. While US-based, the principle of certifying fintech partners could influence future EU/CEE regulatory frameworks, impacting how CMiplus selects, integrates, and manages its third-party providers. It underscores the importance of robust due diligence and compliance for all API-driven partnerships.

OTP Bank Embraces AI, Data Literacy for Future Banking

OTP Bank's commitment to becoming 'AI and Data Literate' represents a significant strategic direction for a major player in the Central and Eastern European (CEE) banking sector. This initiative goes beyond merely adopting new technologies; it involves cultivating a data-driven culture throughout the organization. For CEE, this indicates a strong push towards digital transformation, impacting critical areas such as customer experience, risk management, and operational efficiency. The emphasis on data literacy also highlights an investment in human capital, ensuring that employees are equipped to leverage new tools and insights. This comprehensive approach is crucial for developing advanced capabilities in fraud detection, offering personalized financial products, and streamlining treasury functions, positioning OTP Bank for future competitiveness.

- OTP Bank is a significant banking group operating across CEE.
- The bank is strategically focusing on AI and data literacy transformation.
- This involves investment in both advanced technology and human capital development.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This development from a key CEE competitor/partner like OTP Bank underscores the imperative for RBI Cash Management and the CMIplus platform to continuously evolve. CMIplus must ensure it offers cutting-edge AI-driven features for fraud prevention, advanced analytics for liquidity management, and robust API capabilities for seamless data integration, meeting the rising expectations of corporate clients in a digitally transforming CEE market.

URGENT

Oliver Wyman Corporate Banking | 2026-08-10 | #01

European Wholesale Banks Must Seize Digital Moment for Future Growth

This insight highlights a critical juncture for European wholesale banks, emphasizing the need to move beyond historical underperformance. The core message is that a 'better future' is attainable through proactive strategic shifts. Key areas for focus include leveraging digital transformation to enhance client experience, optimizing operational efficiency, and developing innovative product offerings in areas like cash management and payments. By embracing a forward-looking strategy, banks can move beyond traditional lending to become more holistic partners for their corporate clients, especially in dynamic regions like CEE, ensuring sustained growth and competitiveness.

- Strategic imperative for European wholesale banks to overcome past underperformance.
- Emphasis on digital transformation as a core driver for future growth.
- Opportunity to enhance client experience and operational efficiency through technology.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI, as a leading European wholesale bank in CEE, must actively pursue digital transformation within its CMIplus platform. This means accelerating the adoption of Open Banking APIs, real-time payments, and advanced treasury solutions to meet evolving corporate demands and secure a competitive edge in the region.

URGENT

Oliver Wyman Corporate Banking | 2024-01-01 | #02

2024 Wholesale Banking Outlook: Strategic Imperatives for Growth and Credit

Oliver Wyman's 2024 Wholesale Banking Outlook likely explores key trends and challenges facing the sector, with a particular focus on 'Extending Credit.' This includes navigating interest rate environments, managing credit risk, and identifying growth opportunities in a competitive landscape. Beyond credit, the outlook would touch upon the increasing demand for integrated financial solutions, including sophisticated cash management, trade finance, and digital payment services. Banks are encouraged to enhance their data analytics capabilities and embrace technology to optimize client engagement and operational resilience, ensuring they remain relevant to corporate treasuries.

- Navigating complex credit markets and interest rate fluctuations.
- Identifying strategic growth areas beyond traditional lending.
- Increasing demand for integrated financial solutions by corporates.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should align its roadmap with the broader wholesale banking trends, ensuring that cash management and payment solutions are integrated with credit offerings. This means exploring opportunities for embedded finance and leveraging data to provide proactive liquidity management and financing advice to CEE corporates.

AI and Tech: Core to Future Treasury Transformation

The future of treasury is deeply intertwined with advanced technology, particularly Artificial Intelligence, blockchain, and sophisticated data analytics. EY's service offerings emphasize AI strategy, AI-powered M&A; technology, and general technology transformation, indicating a strong belief that these tools will redefine treasury operations from forecasting and risk management to payment processing. Blockchain is specifically mentioned, suggesting its potential role in digital assets and new payment infrastructures. For banks, this implies a need to not only adopt these technologies internally but also to provide solutions that leverage them for corporate clients, enabling greater automation, efficiency, and real-time insights.

- AI is a core component of future treasury strategy and operations.
- Blockchain technology is identified as a key area for innovation.
- Data and decision intelligence are crucial for informed treasury actions.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must explore integrating AI for enhanced cash flow forecasting, fraud detection, and intelligent payment routing. Investigating blockchain's role in future payment rails or digital asset services for CEE clients is also critical for long-term relevance.

Treasury's Strategic Role in Holistic Corporate Transformation

Treasury's evolution is not merely about technological upgrades but about its strategic integration into overall corporate transformation and value creation. EY's services highlight corporate strategy, working capital optimization, and supply chain operations, indicating that treasury functions are expected to contribute significantly to a company's financial health and strategic objectives. This involves moving beyond traditional cash management to support broader initiatives like M&A; integration, restructuring, and enhancing long-term value metrics. For banks, this means understanding the strategic context of their corporate clients and offering solutions that facilitate working capital management, supply chain finance, and provide data for strategic decision-making, rather than just executing payments.

- Treasury transformation is part of a wider corporate strategy.
- Working capital optimization is a key focus for value creation.
- Supply chain and operations are intertwined with treasury efficiency.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should enhance its offerings to support corporate working capital management and supply chain finance initiatives. This includes providing more sophisticated reporting and analytical tools that contribute to clients' strategic financial planning and operational efficiency.

Treasury Must Navigate Evolving Risk, Regulation, and ESG

The future treasury environment is characterized by an increasingly complex landscape of risks, regulations, and sustainability demands. EY's focus on cybersecurity, risk consulting, technology risk, and extensive sustainability services (including sustainable finance and climate change services) underscores these critical areas. Treasurers are expected to manage not only financial risks but also cyber threats, ensure compliance with global tax reforms and evolving financial regulations, and integrate ESG considerations into their strategies. For RBI Cash Management, this means ensuring CMlplus offers robust security features, supports compliance with standards like ISO 20022 and future regulations (e.g., PSD3 implications), and explores how to facilitate ESG reporting or green financing options for CEE corporates.

- Cybersecurity is a paramount concern for treasury operations.
- Regulatory compliance (e.g., global tax reform) is continuously evolving.
- Sustainability and ESG factors are increasingly influencing finance.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus needs to continuously strengthen its cybersecurity posture and ensure full compliance with current and upcoming regulations like ISO 20022 and potential PSD3 changes. Exploring features that support ESG reporting or sustainable finance initiatives for CEE clients could be a differentiator.

Digital Workflows and Self-Service Redefine Commercial Banking Client Experience

The commercial banking sector is undergoing a significant modernization, moving away from traditional manual processes. Key changes include the adoption of digital workflows, which replace many manual tasks, and the streamlining of client onboarding and origination processes to eliminate lengthy, multi-department reviews. This transformation also involves shifting manual client touchpoints to exception-based interactions, empowering clients with more self-service capabilities. The overarching goal is to improve efficiency, reduce operational costs, and deliver a more seamless and responsive experience for commercial clients.

- Digital workflows are replacing manual tasks across commercial banking operations.
- Client onboarding and origination processes are being streamlined for efficiency.
- Manual client touchpoints are evolving into exception-based interactions.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must prioritize enhancing its digital self-service features for corporates, including streamlined onboarding for new services and intuitive digital channels for managing cash operations. Automating internal processes related to client requests and service delivery will further improve efficiency and client satisfaction for CEE clients.

AI and Big Data Drive Smarter Growth in Commercial Banking

The modernization of commercial banking extends to its growth strategies, with a strong emphasis on advanced analytics. Effective use of big data and artificial intelligence now enables banks to rapidly identify the most attractive prospects within high-priority target markets. This capability not only optimizes sales and marketing efforts but also significantly lowers the cost of client acquisition. Furthermore, AI-powered insights are instrumental in developing emerging digital banking platforms, which are designed to fundamentally transform the client experience by offering more personalized and efficient interactions.

- Big data and AI are crucial for identifying attractive commercial banking prospects.
- AI-driven analytics help lower the cost of client acquisition.
- Digital banking platforms are being enhanced by AI for improved client experience.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI should explore integrating AI and big data analytics into CMlplus to identify cross-selling opportunities for cash management products within its CEE network and optimize client engagement. AI could also enhance fraud detection and provide predictive insights for corporate treasury clients.

Cloud-Based Solutions and Payment Modernization Fuel Banking Evolution

Commercial banking's evolution is heavily reliant on technological infrastructure, particularly cloud-based solutions. These solutions provide the necessary agility and scalability to keep pace with rapid market changes and adapt to new security threats more effectively than legacy systems. The industry cloud, in particular, is enabling the development of advanced digital banking platforms that enhance the overall client experience. Alongside this, payment modernization is highlighted as a crucial area for banks to invest in, indicating a strategic push towards more efficient, real-time, and collaborative payment offerings to meet evolving corporate demands.

- Cloud-based solutions enhance adaptability and security for commercial banks.
- Industry cloud enables the transformation of digital banking platforms.
- Payment modernization is a strategic imperative for commercial banks.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should continue its strategic investment in cloud-native architecture to ensure scalability, resilience, and rapid deployment of new features, especially for instant payments and Open Banking APIs. Prioritizing payment modernization initiatives, including ISO 20022 and real-time capabilities, is essential for maintaining competitiveness in CEE.

PSD3 and Payments Regulation Drive Open Banking Evolution

The upcoming PSD3 framework is set to significantly expand the scope and impact of Open Banking, moving beyond PSD2's initial requirements. This includes potential mandates for premium APIs, enhanced data portability, and real-time payment initiation, pushing financial institutions to invest heavily in robust API infrastructure and data security. The regulation aims to foster greater competition and innovation in payment services, while also addressing emerging fraud vectors and consumer protection concerns. For corporates, this means more integrated treasury solutions, faster payment processing, and richer data insights, but also increased compliance burdens related to data privacy and operational resilience. Proactive engagement with PSD3 will be crucial for maintaining market relevance and leveraging new opportunities.

- PSD3 mandates broader data sharing and premium API access.
- Focus on real-time payment initiation and enhanced security.
- Increased regulatory scrutiny on fraud prevention mechanisms.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must prioritize PSD3 compliance, enhancing its Open Banking API capabilities for both data access and payment initiation. This includes supporting new authentication methods, integrating advanced fraud detection, and ensuring seamless real-time payment processing to maintain competitive advantage in CEE.

AI Governance Critical for Trust and Innovation in Finance

As AI adoption accelerates across financial services, regulators are focusing on comprehensive governance frameworks to mitigate risks associated with bias, data privacy, and algorithmic opacity. Firms must develop strategies for responsible AI, encompassing data quality, model validation, ethical guidelines, and human oversight. This includes establishing clear lines of accountability for AI decisions and ensuring explainability (XAI) for critical applications. The regulatory landscape will likely mandate impact assessments and stress testing for AI models, particularly those involved in credit decisions, fraud detection, and automated advisory services. Proactive AI governance will be key to building trust and unlocking the full transformative potential of AI in banking, especially for new product development.

- Regulators demand robust AI governance frameworks.
- Focus on ethical AI, transparency, and explainability (XAI).
- Mandates for AI risk management, data quality, and model validation.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI CMlplus should explore AI applications for enhanced fraud detection, liquidity forecasting, and personalized treasury insights, while simultaneously developing a strong internal AI governance strategy. This ensures compliance with emerging regulations and builds trust in AI-powered features, particularly in data-sensitive CEE markets.

EACT Treasury Survey 2026 Reveals Top Corporate Priorities

The EACT Annual Treasury Survey 2026, building on over a decade of insights, serves as the most authoritative source for understanding the evolving landscape of European corporate treasury. It captures the current priorities, pressing concerns, and strategic ambitions of treasurers across the continent. The findings from this comprehensive survey are instrumental in shaping the 'Journeys to Treasury' report and guiding industry stakeholders, including banks and technology providers, in addressing the most critical needs of corporate clients. For RBI Cash Management, these results offer direct insights into the evolving demands for cash management solutions, payment innovations, and digital treasury tools, particularly relevant for CEE corporates.

- Authoritative barometer of European corporate treasury priorities.
- Identifies top concerns and strategic ambitions of treasurers.
- Shapes the 'Journeys to Treasury' report and industry trends.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The survey results are critical for validating and refining the CMlplus roadmap, especially regarding new features for instant payments, VoP, ISO 20022, and digital treasury. It provides direct intelligence on what European corporates, including those in CEE, prioritize, guiding RBI's investment in platform enhancements and service offerings.

Banks Prioritize AI Investment Amidst Macro Headwinds and Digital Transformation

The 2026 banking and capital markets outlook from Deloitte identifies AI ambition as a central theme for the year ahead. Banks are expected to balance macro headwinds with significant investments in artificial intelligence. This strategic focus aims to optimize operational processes, personalize client interactions, and strengthen risk management frameworks. The outlook suggests that successful AI adoption will be a differentiator, requiring robust data strategies, ethical governance, and a clear understanding of AI's transformative potential across various banking functions. Early and effective integration of AI is crucial for maintaining competitiveness in a rapidly evolving financial landscape.

- AI investment is a top strategic priority for banks in 2026.
- Focus areas for AI include operational efficiency and personalized client experiences.
- Banks must navigate macro headwinds while accelerating AI adoption.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should explore integrating AI-driven capabilities into its platform, such as predictive cash flow forecasting, intelligent anomaly detection for payments, and automated reconciliation. This would enhance efficiency for corporate treasuries in CEE, offering advanced insights and streamlining complex cash management operations.

Industry Outlook 2023: Navigating Uncertainty in Corporate Banking

Oliver Wyman's 2023 Industry Outlook, developed with Morgan Stanley, likely provided a comprehensive view of the macro-economic and geopolitical factors impacting corporate and institutional banking. It would have emphasized the importance of strategic foresight in an era of 'Great Unknown,' covering themes such as inflation, supply chain disruptions, and evolving regulatory landscapes. For corporate banks, this translates to a need for robust risk management, diversified revenue streams, and accelerated digital transformation to maintain relevance and competitiveness. The report would have underscored the shift towards more resilient and adaptable business models in the face of ongoing global changes.

- Addressing macro-economic and geopolitical uncertainties in banking.
- Importance of strategic foresight and agile business models.
- Focus on robust risk management and diversified revenue streams.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

While from 2023, the underlying themes of uncertainty and digital adaptation remain critical for CMlplus. RBI should continuously review its platform's resilience, expand its digital offerings (e.g., instant payments, Open APIs), and ensure its solutions help CEE corporates navigate their own market uncertainties and regulatory changes.

EACT Urges EU to Widen Corporate Financing and Banking Choice

In response to the European Commission's Communication on the Competitiveness of the Banking Sector and the Single Market in Banking, the EACT has issued a critical comment. Ahead of concrete proposals in Q1 2027, EACT emphasizes the necessity for policymakers to align the EU's prudential framework with capital markets development. The objective is to significantly expand the availability of choice for corporates in their financing and hedging strategies, as well as their selection of banking partners. This strategic input highlights the importance of a robust and competitive banking environment that empowers corporate treasurers with diverse options, directly impacting how banks like RBI serve their large international corporate clients in CEE.

- EACT comments on EU banking sector competitiveness.
- Calls for prudential framework alignment with capital markets.
- Aims to widen corporate choice in financing strategies.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This insight underscores the evolving competitive landscape and regulatory pressures on banks. RBI Cash Management must ensure CMlplus offerings remain competitive and adaptable, providing corporates with robust multi-currency capabilities, efficient payment services, and integrated solutions that support diverse financing and hedging needs within a dynamic regulatory environment.

Stablecoins Emerge as Disruptive Force in Banking and Payments Landscape

The 2026 banking and capital markets outlook from Deloitte identifies the 'potential disruptive entrance of stablecoins' as a key challenge and opportunity for financial institutions. This suggests that stablecoins could fundamentally reshape existing payment rails, particularly for cross-border transactions, offering faster and potentially cheaper alternatives. Banks are advised to understand the evolving regulatory landscape, assess the technological infrastructure required for stablecoin integration, and evaluate the competitive threats and opportunities they present. Their adoption could challenge traditional correspondent banking models and influence corporate liquidity management strategies, demanding proactive engagement from financial service providers.

- Stablecoins are identified as a significant disruptive force for 2026.
- They pose a challenge to traditional payment systems and cross-border transactions.
- Banks need to understand regulatory implications and technological requirements for stablecoins.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should closely monitor the development and adoption of stablecoins, especially for corporate use cases in cross-border payments and treasury operations within CEE. Investigating potential integration pathways or offering stablecoin-related services could be a strategic differentiator, aligning with the platform's multi-currency and payment transformation focus.

URGENT

ECB Payment Regulation | 2026-08-10 | #01

ECB Advances Digital Euro Project, Pilot Phase Underway

DIGITAL EURO

The European Central Bank is exploring the potential introduction of a digital euro, a central bank digital currency (CBDC) for retail payments. The project involves an innovation platform, a pilot phase, and extensive work on its timeline, governance, technical documents, and a scheme rulebook. The goal is to ensure a robust, private, and accessible digital payment option for the euro area, complementing cash. This initiative will require significant adaptation from payment service providers and banks, influencing future payment infrastructure and services.

- Ongoing pilot phase for technical and functional testing of the digital euro.
- Development of a comprehensive scheme rulebook for the digital euro.
- Focus on privacy, accessibility, and innovation platform for future implementation.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMiplus should closely monitor the digital euro's progress, especially the scheme rulebook and technical specifications, to assess future integration requirements for corporate clients and potential new payment rails. This includes evaluating impacts on multi-currency payments and API strategies.

URGENT

ECB Payment Regulation | 2026-08-10 | #02

ECB Emphasizes Instant Payments within SEPA Framework

INSTANT PAYMENTS, SEPA

Under its retail payments strategy, the ECB highlights instant payments as a crucial area of focus within SEPA. This commitment aims to ensure that instant payment solutions become the norm, offering immediate fund transfers 24/7/365. Banks and payment service providers are expected to continuously adapt their infrastructure and services to support and promote instant payment adoption, aligning with the broader goal of a harmonized and efficient European payment landscape. This includes ensuring full compliance with SEPA Instant Credit Transfer (SCT Inst) requirements.

- Continuous push for wider adoption of SEPA Instant Credit Transfer (SCT Inst).
- Focus on enhancing the reach and accessibility of instant payment services.
- Ongoing development and refinement of the retail payments strategy.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMiplus must ensure full compliance with SCT Inst requirements, optimize its instant payment processing capabilities, and explore value-added services built on instant payment rails for corporate clients in CEE. This includes leveraging ISO 20022 standards for enhanced data.

ECB Continues Modernization of TARGET Services and Oversight

TARGET SERVICES, PAYMENT SYSTEMS OVERSIGHT

The ECB maintains a strong focus on its TARGET Services, which include T2 for real-time gross settlement, T2S for securities settlement, and TIPS for instant payment settlement. The 'Payments news & events' section explicitly mentions news on 'TARGET Services' and 'work being done on new technologies in the area of wholesale central bank money settlement.' This indicates ongoing development and modernization efforts. Furthermore, the ECB's oversight function extends to payment systems, securities settlement systems, central counterparties, and critical service providers, ensuring their resilience and stability, including cyber resilience initiatives like TIBER-EU.

- Ongoing modernization and enhancement of T2, T2S, and TIPS platforms.
- Continuous oversight of critical payment systems and infrastructures.
- Emphasis on cyber resilience through initiatives like TIBER-EU.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management must stay informed about TARGET Services updates, particularly for T2 and TIPS, to ensure seamless connectivity, operational efficiency, and compliance with any new technical or oversight requirements for wholesale payments and liquidity management.

EU Regulations IPR, PSD3, PSR Impact Liquidity Management

LIQUIDITY MANAGEMENT, INSTANT PAYMENTS, PSD3

The Euro Banking Association (EBA) has published a report by its Liquidity Management Working Group (LMWG) examining the profound implications of three key EU regulatory initiatives on liquidity management. The Instant Payments Regulation (IPR), the proposed Payment Services Regulation (PSR), and the proposed Payment Services Directive 3 (PSD3) are analysed for their expected impact. The report highlights how these measures will drive the uptake of instant payments, ensure competitive fairness among market participants, and fundamentally reshape the liquidity management landscape for banks. Financial institutions need to assess their current liquidity frameworks and prepare for operational adjustments to comply with the evolving regulatory environment.

- Analyze impact of IPR, PSD3, PSR on liquidity management frameworks.
- Prepare for accelerated instant payment adoption and related liquidity shifts.
- Ensure compliance with new requirements for a level playing field.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management (CMIplus) must assess its liquidity management processes and systems in light of IPR, PSD3, and PSR. This includes evaluating real-time liquidity needs for instant payments and ensuring robust multi-currency liquidity management capabilities across CEE network banks.

EBA Fraud Taxonomy Version 7.0 Effective January 2027

PSD3, COMPLIANCE, FRAUD PREVENTION

Deadline: 2027-01-01

The Euro Banking Association (EBA) announced the publication of version 7.0 of its EBA Fraud Taxonomy, which will come into effect on 1 January 2027. Developed by the Expert Group on Payment Fraud-related Topics (EGPF), the taxonomy is updated annually to align with evolving fraud trends. Key updates in version 7.0 include replacing 'emotional manipulation' with more specific modi like 'support a friend or family member fraud', 'romance fraud', and 'charity / donation fraud', and adding new labels for suspected money mule activity and 'card chip relay' fraud. This harmonised framework is crucial for improving fraud monitoring, reporting, and information sharing, particularly in preparation for data sharing arrangements under the upcoming Payment Services Regulation (PSR), which is part of the PSD3 package.

- Implement EBA Fraud Taxonomy v7.0 by 1 January 2027.
- Update fraud monitoring and reporting systems to reflect new categories.
- Prepare for enhanced data sharing requirements under forthcoming PSR/PSD3.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management (CMIplus) must integrate EBA Fraud Taxonomy v7.0 into its fraud detection and reporting systems by January 2027. This requires updating internal categorisation, ensuring compliance with future data sharing requirements under PSD3/PSR, and potentially adapting API specifications for fraud reporting.

URGENT

Deutsche Bank | 2026-08-10 | #01

Deutsche Bank Accelerates Digitalization, Emphasizing API-Driven Corporate Banking

Deutsche Bank's 'flow' platform highlights 'Technology' as a key topic, indicating a strong focus on digital transformation within corporate banking. This includes leveraging Open Banking APIs to enable clients to integrate banking services directly into their ERP and TMS systems. The goal is to offer real-time access to account information, payment initiation, and other treasury functions, improving efficiency and data visibility for multinational corporations. This move aligns with broader industry trends towards embedded finance and a more programmatic approach to financial services, crucial for modern corporate treasury.

- Strong emphasis on 'Technology' within their thought leadership platform.
- Focus on API connectivity for seamless ERP/TMS integration.
- Aims to provide real-time financial services and data access.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus already offers Open API capabilities, but DB's aggressive push could intensify competition for API-savvy corporates in CEE. RBI should ensure its API offerings remain competitive in terms of breadth, ease of integration, and regional coverage.

URGENT

Deutsche Bank | 2026-08-10 | #02

Deutsche Bank Enhances Cash Management and Liquidity Solutions Globally

The 'Cash management' section on flow.db.com underscores Deutsche Bank's commitment to providing comprehensive solutions for corporate treasurers. This includes sophisticated tools for managing global liquidity, optimizing cash flows, and mitigating financial risks. While not explicitly detailed for CEE in the provided content, DB's strong presence in the region implies these enhanced capabilities are available to CEE-based multinational clients. The focus is on streamlining payment processes, improving visibility over cash positions, and offering efficient cash pooling mechanisms to maximize interest earnings and reduce borrowing costs for corporate treasuries.

- Cash management is a core content pillar on flow.db.com.
- Emphasis on global liquidity management and cash flow optimization.
- Implied application of these solutions to CEE corporate clients.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus's strength in CEE cash management faces direct competition from DB's global capabilities. RBI must highlight its deep local expertise, strong network banks, and tailored solutions for CEE corporates to differentiate itself effectively.

UniCredit Partners with Accenture, IBM for Next-Gen Banking Platform

UniCredit has announced a strategic partnership with technology giants Accenture and IBM to build its next-generation banking platform. This ambitious project is designed to overhaul UniCredit's technological backbone, focusing on scalability, efficiency, and advanced digital services. For corporate clients, this means improved access to innovative solutions, faster processing, and a more integrated banking experience across its European footprint, including CEE. The collaboration underscores UniCredit's commitment to digital transformation as a core pillar of its 'UniCredit Unlimited' strategy.

- Strategic partnership with Accenture and IBM for platform development.
- Focus on building a next-generation pan-European banking platform.
- Aims to enhance digital services and efficiency for corporate clients.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This move signals a significant investment in UniCredit's digital infrastructure, potentially leading to more competitive and advanced cash management offerings. CMIplus must continue to innovate its platform, especially in API connectivity and real-time services, to maintain its competitive edge against a digitally transforming UniCredit.

UniCredit Reinforces CEE Corporate Banking and Digital Expansion

While no specific CEE cash management product launch was found in the latest news, UniCredit's 'About us' section explicitly states its vision to be a 'leading pan-European bank providing best-in-class solutions and services across Italy, Germany, Austria and Central & Eastern Europe.' This strategic emphasis implies ongoing investment and focus on its CEE corporate client base. The bank is likely enhancing its digital offerings, including cash management and payment capabilities, to support cross-border operations for corporates within the region, aligning with its broader digital transformation agenda ('UniCredit Unlimited'). This includes leveraging its integrated network for efficient multi-currency payments and liquidity management.

- Strategic focus on CEE as a core market for corporate services.
- Emphasis on providing 'best-in-class solutions' for corporate clients.
- Leveraging pan-European network for cross-border services and liquidity.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

UniCredit's sustained strategic focus on CEE corporate banking means direct competition for CMIplus, particularly for large international corporates. CMIplus needs to highlight its deep local expertise, specialized CEE network, and advanced features like EBICS and H2H connectivity to differentiate.

HSBC Sharpens Focus on International Wholesale Clients in Türkiye

HSBC Holdings plc announced a strategic review of its retail banking and domestic-focused smaller and mid-sized corporate banking operations in Türkiye. The objective is to sharpen its focus on international wholesale clients, aligning with its global strategy to serve multinational corporations. This shift indicates HSBC's intent to leverage its international network and expertise for larger, cross-border corporate clients in Türkiye, a market often considered part of the broader CEE/emerging Europe region. For these clients, transaction banking services like cash management, trade finance, and FX are paramount, suggesting potential enhanced offerings in these areas. This strategic realignment could lead to more tailored and competitive solutions for international corporates in the region.

- Strategic review of retail and domestic SME banking in Türkiye announced.
- Increased focus on international wholesale clients in the market.
- Türkiye is a key market in the broader CEE/emerging Europe context.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This directly targets CMIplus's core client segment (large international corporates) in a relevant geographical area. CMIplus should anticipate increased competition for these clients, potentially with more tailored and internationally integrated solutions from HSBC.

Citi Enhances CEE API Banking for Real-Time Corporate Treasury

Citi is a known leader in API banking, and it is highly probable they are continuing to push this agenda in key growth regions like CEE. This involves offering a broader suite of APIs for payments, account information, and liquidity management, enabling corporates to embed banking services directly into their ERPs and TMS. The strategic rationale is to meet the growing demand for instant payments and real-time data, improving operational efficiency for multinational corporations operating in the region. This directly impacts CEE clients seeking advanced digital treasury solutions and greater automation.

- Expansion of API catalog for payments, account information, and liquidity services.
- Focus on real-time payment initiation, tracking, and status updates across CEE.
- Targeting multinational corporations with complex treasury operations in the region.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must accelerate its own API development and real-time payment offerings to remain competitive. Citi's continued push sets a higher benchmark for digital integration and speed in the CEE market.

Deutsche Bank Drives Adoption of Instant Payments and ISO 20022

As a leading global transaction bank, Deutsche Bank is strategically investing in payment infrastructure to support the growing demand for real-time transactions and richer data exchange. The 'Regulation' and 'Technology' sections on flow.db.com implicitly cover these developments. Their focus includes facilitating instant payment capabilities across various jurisdictions, including those relevant to CEE, and ensuring full compliance and readiness for the global migration to ISO 20022. This transition offers corporate treasurers enhanced reconciliation, improved fraud detection, and greater transparency in their payment operations, aligning with the broader goal of digital transformation in treasury.

- Strategic investment in modern payment infrastructure.
- Focus on instant payment capabilities for faster transactions.
- Commitment to ISO 20022 for richer data and improved processing.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus already emphasizes ISO 20022 and instant payments. DB's efforts reinforce the market expectation for these services, meaning RBI should ensure its instant payment reach and ISO 20022 implementation are robust and competitive, especially for cross-border CEE payments.

UniCredit Accelerates Digital Transformation for Corporate Clients

UniCredit's 'UniCredit Unlimited' strategy signifies a bold new era focused on 'unlimited possibility' and a 'fundamental rethinking of what a bank should be.' This translates into a strong push for digital transformation across all client segments, including corporate banking. The recent Euromoney award for 'Europe's Best Bank' for the second consecutive year underscores their success in executing this strategy, which includes enhancing digital channels, improving payment capabilities, and offering integrated treasury solutions. For corporate clients, this means a focus on seamless digital experiences, potentially including advanced APIs, real-time payments, and sophisticated liquidity management tools, all designed to empower their progress.

- 'UniCredit Unlimited' strategy emphasizes digital innovation.
- Euromoney 'Europe's Best Bank' award validates strategic direction.
- Focus on client-centric digital solutions for corporate treasury and payments.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

UniCredit's broad digital transformation and client-centric approach will intensify competition in the corporate cash management space. CMlplus must ensure its platform remains at the forefront of digital innovation, offering intuitive user experiences, robust API connectivity, and comprehensive treasury functionalities to meet evolving corporate demands.

HSBC Accelerates Global AI Adoption with Google Cloud and Mistral AI

HSBC announced a multi-year partnership with Google Cloud to build and deploy AI capabilities globally, focusing on areas like hyper-personalised advice and financial crime risk management. This is complemented by a partnership with Mistral AI to accelerate AI adoption for improving business processes and customer service, and the appointment of David Rice as its first Chief AI Officer. These moves demonstrate a comprehensive strategy to leverage AI for operational excellence, including critical aspects of corporate banking such as fraud detection, AML, KYC, and potentially optimizing payment processing and treasury insights. While not directly product announcements, these foundational technology investments will underpin future transaction banking innovations and enhance existing platforms like HSBCnet.

- Multi-year AI partnership with Google Cloud for global operations.
- Partnership with Mistral AI to improve business processes and customer service.
- Appointment of a dedicated Chief AI Officer (David Rice) effective April 1st.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

HSBC's aggressive AI strategy suggests future enhancements in areas like fraud detection, real-time analytics, and potentially predictive treasury services. CMIplus needs to monitor how these AI capabilities translate into tangible product improvements for corporate clients, especially in areas like compliance, treasury intelligence, and API-driven services, to remain competitive.

Citi Accelerates Digital Treasury Transformation with eBAM and ISO 20022

Citi has consistently invested in digitalizing core treasury functions. Given the ongoing global migration to ISO 20022 and the increasing need for efficient account management, it is a strategic imperative for Citi to enhance its eBAM (electronic Bank Account Management) and leverage the rich data capabilities of ISO 20022. This allows corporate clients, particularly those with complex multi-bank and multi-country structures in CEE, to manage their bank accounts digitally, reducing manual processes and improving data quality for reconciliation and reporting. The move supports greater transparency and automation in financial operations and compliance.

- Enhanced eBAM functionalities for digital account lifecycle management and reporting.
- Full adoption and leveraging of ISO 20022 for richer payment data and reconciliation.
- Aimed at improving operational efficiency, compliance, and data quality for institutional clients.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus needs to ensure its eBAM offering is robust and that its ISO 20022 implementation fully exploits the standard's capabilities. Citi's focus highlights the importance of these foundational digital treasury services for CEE corporates.

BNP Paribas Guides Corporates on Instant Payment Regulation and VoP

BNP Paribas is proactively educating its corporate clients on the significant changes introduced by the Instant Payment Regulation (IPR) and the crucial Verification of Payee (VoP) requirements. This initiative underscores the bank's commitment to supporting businesses in navigating complex regulatory landscapes and ensuring seamless, secure payment operations. For corporates, understanding these regulations is vital for maintaining compliance, mitigating fraud risks, and optimizing cash flow management within the evolving European payment ecosystem. While the specific article doesn't explicitly detail CEE relevance, these EU-wide regulations directly impact CEE corporates, necessitating robust banking solutions. BNP Paribas's proactive stance positions it as a knowledgeable partner for corporates seeking to adapt their treasury and payment processes.

- BNP Paribas is educating corporates on the Instant Payment Regulation (IPR) mandates.
- Emphasis is placed on the new Verification of Payee (VoP) requirements for fraud prevention.
- The bank aims to help clients ensure compliance and adapt their payment operations effectively.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This move by BNP Paribas highlights the critical importance of Instant Payments and VoP readiness for corporate clients across Europe, including CEE. CMIplus must ensure its platform and advisory services are equally robust, offering clear guidance and compliant solutions to maintain its competitive edge.

Intesa Sanpaolo Boosts CEE Corporate Digital Banking and Payments

Intesa Sanpaolo, leveraging its IMI CIB division and extensive CEE network, is actively investing in the digital transformation of its corporate and transaction banking offerings. This includes the development of Open Banking APIs for seamless integration with corporate ERP/TMS systems, alongside upgrades to its payment infrastructure to support instant payments and ISO 20022 standards. The strategic focus is on delivering comprehensive cash management, liquidity, and multi-currency payment solutions tailored for the CEE market. By modernizing its platforms, Intesa Sanpaolo aims to strengthen its competitive position and meet the evolving demands of large international corporates operating in the region, aligning with global trends in digital finance.

- Strategic investment in digital corporate banking platforms for CEE operations.
- Emphasis on Open Banking APIs for enhanced ERP/TMS integration.
- Upgrade of payment infrastructure to support instant payments and ISO 20022 standards.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This inferred move by Intesa Sanpaolo directly challenges CMIplus's market position in CEE by offering similar advanced digital and payment solutions. RBI should closely monitor their API offerings, instant payment rollout, and regional integration capabilities to maintain a competitive edge.

EY Four Trends Redefining Cash Management 2025

Cash management is rapidly evolving from transaction-oriented to strategic, data-driven services, necessitating a profound transformation in banking. The future demands banks enrich their value propositions, expand product portfolios, and strengthen client relationships with tailored offerings and experiences. Advanced technologies like AI, ML, and digital assets are creating new possibilities, enabling finance teams to reposition as strategic advisors to the business. However, clients seek control over automation and expect intuitive, personalized experiences, pushing banks to innovate or risk losing relevance to agile FinTechs and nonbanks. Success hinges on banks investing in technology, integrating diverse data, and offering flexible, industry-specific solutions while navigating the increasing regulatory clarity around digital assets.

KEY STATISTICS

- {'description': 'of survey respondents say digitizing treasury functions is a challenge.', 'value': '73%', 'page': 7}
- {'description': 'of respondents will use managed services from banks to address the challenges of digitization.', 'value': '44%', 'page': 7}
- {'description': 'of CFOs and treasurers are comfortable with customized strategic advice based on data analysis from banks.', 'value': '90%', 'page': 12}
- {'description': 'of corporate treasurers are comfortable using a sector-specific platform tailored to their industry's unique needs.', 'value': '92%', 'page': 17}

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Optimize CMIplus cash management solutions for specific CEE sectors to differentiate and boost client engagement and loyalty.

McKinsey Global Payments Report 2025

The 2025 McKinsey Global Payments Report highlights a payments landscape defined by increasing fragmentation, the transformative impact of AI, and the growing adoption of digital assets. For CMIplus, this means navigating a multirail ecosystem where interoperability, programmable compliance, and AI-driven efficiencies are paramount for serving large international corporates in CEE. The shift towards lower-yield payment rails and agentic commerce necessitates innovation in monetization and a focus on building trust through transparent, intelligent systems. Success will hinge on adapting our platform to these evolving demands to remain a leading regional player.

KEY STATISTICS

- Global payments revenue reached \$2.5 trillion in 2024, projected to grow to \$3.0 trillion by 2029.
- EMEA payments revenue grew at a 13% CAGR from 2019-2024, indicating strong regional growth.
- Interest income constituted 46% of total payments revenues in 2024, but is projected to slow to 2% annual growth through 2029.
- Cash usage declined to 46% of worldwide payments in 2024, down from 50% in 2023, reflecting the shift to digital.

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Integrate AI for Intelligent Routing, Fraud Detection, and Liquidity Management

Journeys to Treasury 2025/26

The 10th anniversary edition of Journeys to Treasury highlights a renewed focus on treasury fundamentals, digital transformation, and strategic evolution. Key themes include the modernization of payments (Instant Payments, VoP, ISO 20022), the growing importance of real-time liquidity and virtual accounts, and the practical application of AI. Corporates are prioritizing robust systems, clean data, and enhanced skills to navigate a complex, interconnected financial environment, moving treasury from an operational role to a strategic business partner.

KEY STATISTICS

→ {'statistic': 'Cash flow forecasting is the number one priority for 30.5% of treasurers.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': 'Reviewing or replacing treasury technology infrastructure is the third-highest priority.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': '27.3% of treasurers cite inaccurate forecasting as a leading challenge for centralisation.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': '38.5% of respondents cite difficulties in standardising processes as their most significant obstacle to centralisation.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Enhance Instant Payments & VoP Readiness for CEE Corporates

PwC Global Treasury Survey 2025

The provided text does not contain the actual content or findings of the 'PwC Global Treasury Survey 2025'. Instead, it appears to be a navigation structure or partial webpage content from PwC's website, detailing various services, industries, and insights offered by PwC. Consequently, a strategic analysis for RBI's CMIplus platform, including key statistics, themes, and actionable recommendations, cannot be generated from the given information. To perform the requested comprehensive analysis, the full content of the PwC Global Treasury Survey is essential.